

Earth, Wind & Fire Style Funk Bass

Style patch. ~126 BPM (September / Let's Groove territory).

GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

The style

Verdine White is the reference: a busy, syncopated fingerstyle funk part that stays locked with the drums and a big horn section.

The tone is bright, punchy, and tightly compressed, with clear note definition. It has to cut through horns and a stacked rhythm section without getting boomy.

Other players in the same lane: Louis Johnson (Brothers Johnson), Rocco Prestia (Tower of Power), and Larry Graham (Graham Central Station) on the slap side.

This patch gives you two sounds: Verdine's fingerstyle pocket in the base state, and a scooped Louis Johnson-style thumb-and-pop tone on CTL.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: EBS410 IR (User IR 4)

SVT is the default 70s R&B studio/live bass amp. It's clean here, with the mids pointed at 800Hz for finger attack. EBS410's 2-3kHz hi-mid push is built for clean tones that have to sit in a dense mix.

- Gain: 25. Clean with headroom, so funk dynamics stay intact.
- Bass: 55. Enough bottom without muddying the kick.
- Middle: 55, MidFreq: 800Hz. Finger attack and note definition.
- Treble: 60. Bright on purpose, because this is a roundwound funk sound.
- VOL: 65. CAB VOL: 58.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 15. Tidies up the rests. Funk depends on silence between notes.

PRE -- COMP4 (Keeley C4), always on.

Sustain: 55, Attack: 45, Clip: 30, VOL: 60.

Fairly firm squash for the even, locked-in level funk needs.

Attack at 45 lets the initial transient through first, so notes still pop.

DST -- off. Funk bass stays clean. No grit.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on. Gain 25, Bass 55, Middle 55, MidFreq 800Hz, Treble 60, VOL 65.

CAB -- User IR 4 (EBS410), always on. VOL 58.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, on CTL.

50Hz: +4, 120Hz: +1, 400Hz: -5, 800Hz: -1, 4.5kHz: +5, VOL: 58.

This is the slap scoop. Deep lows for the thumb, a 400Hz cut to remove the boxiness, and 4.5kHz up for the pop and string zing.

VOL 58 makes up for the level lost to the scoop, so the slap sound doesn't drop in the mix.

MOD -- off. Verdine's tone is dry and direct.

DLY -- off.

RVB -- off. Funk bass wants to be dry and on top of the beat.

CTL footswitch

One module on CTL: EQ (Bass EQ 2).

- **CTL off:** fingerstyle pocket, the Verdine White sound. Mid-forward, bright, compressed. This is the resting state.
- **CTL on:** slap/pop feature. The scooped EQ gives a Louis Johnson thumb-and-pop tone for breakdowns and bass features.

Stomp it when you switch from fingers to thumb. Stomp it off when you go back to the pocket.